

- Prepare a matrix with hypotheses across the top and each piece of evidence on the side. Determine whether each piece of evidence is consistent, inconsistent, or not applicable to each hypothesis.⁵
 - Refine the matrix and reconsider the hypotheses—in some cases, analysts will need to add new hypotheses and re-examine the information available.
 - Focus on disproving hypotheses rather than proving one. Tally the pieces of evidence that are inconsistent and consistent with each hypothesis to see which explanations are the weakest and strongest.
 - Analyze how sensitive the ACH results are to a few critical items of evidence; should those pieces prove to be wrong, misleading, or subject to deception, how would it impact an explanation's validity?
 - Ask what evidence is not being seen but would be expected for a given hypothesis to be true. Is denial and deception a possibility?
 - Report all the conclusions, including the weaker hypotheses that should still be monitored as new information becomes available.
 - Establish the relative likelihood for the hypotheses and report all the conclusions, including the weaker hypotheses that should still be monitored as new information becomes available.
 - Identify and monitor indicators that would be both consistent and inconsistent with the full set of hypotheses. In the latter case, explore what could account for inconsistent data.
- ⁵ The “diagnostic value” of the evidence will emerge as analysts determine whether a piece of evidence is found to be consistent with only one hypothesis, or could support more than one or indeed all hypotheses. In the latter case, the evidence can be judged as unimportant to determining which hypothesis is more likely correct.

Terrorism in Tokyo From Aum Shinrikyo						
		Weight	H: 1	H: 4	H: 2	H: 3
			Kooky Cult	Terrorist Group	Political Movement	Criminal Group
	Inconsistency Score ➡		-1.0	-1.0	-2.0	-3.0
E3	Attacks on Journalists	MEDIUM	I	N	I	I
E2	Religious Affiliation	MEDIUM	C	I	I	I
E4	Established Party	MEDIUM	N	N	C	I
E1	Blind Leader Mastsumoto	MEDIUM	C	C	C	C

ACH Matrix of Terrorism in Tokyo. In March 1995, a largely unknown group attacked the Tokyo subways by using a highly lethal nerve agent known as sarin. ACH provides a mechanism to carefully examine all the evidence and possible explanations for understanding what type of group could have been responsible. In simplified form, the above matrix arrays each piece of evidence on the vertical axis and then evaluates each in terms of the item's consistency with four possible explanations for the terrorist attack in Tokyo (horizontal axis). Analysts rate a piece of evidence as consistent (C); inconsistent (I); or neutral (N). This process allows analysts to see that some evidence will be consistent with more than one hypothesis and be less valuable in disproving hypotheses.